



COVER STORY · ERNAKULAM

Every skill can become an act of care

A beautician, a phone call, and a family who had waited months for someone to help safely.

Pictured: an Onam food kit reaching a family at home, Ernakulam.

ISSUE 39 · SEP 2026

01 · COVER STORY

Restoring comfort through compassionate care

Every person carries a skill that can ease someone else's burden.

The Arike team recently received a call from the family of a bedbound person living with Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA). His fingernails and toenails had not been trimmed for several months. An earlier attempt had resulted in an accidental cut and bleeding, leaving the family understandably worried about trying again. They were looking for someone who could help safely and professionally.

The team remembered a conversation from several months earlier. During a visit to Arike, Dr. Sunil Kumar from IMA Cochin had mentioned that his wife, Padmaja, was a professional beautician who wanted to use her free time to support people who were unable to leave their homes and needed assistance with personal grooming.

When the Arike team reached out to Padmaja, she readily agreed to help. She visited the patient at home and provided attentive, professional care. With patience and precision, she carefully trimmed, shaped and cleaned his fingernails and toenails, taking every precaution so that he felt no discomfort.



“I'm always happy to step in when I have time during the day. It's a wonderful feeling knowing a simple skill can bring someone real relief. I just hope that by sharing this, others feel inspired to step forward and do the same.”

Mrs. Padmaja Sunilkumar · volunteer

Her visit did not end with grooming. She spent time with the patient and his family, listening to their concerns and offering practical advice and guidance. Her willingness to stay, listen and engage with them brought an added sense of reassurance and support. For the patient it was a small but meaningful restoration of comfort. For his family it brought relief after months of worry and hesitation. But Padmaja saw the experience as something more than simply providing a grooming service.

Her words capture something at the heart of palliative care: care is not limited to medicines, procedures or clinical interventions. A beautician's skill, offered at the right moment, became a source of comfort. A simple act of grooming, accompanied by her time, attention and guidance, helped restore a sense of normalcy and dignity to someone living with significant physical limitations.

There are many people in our communities who have skills, time and a willingness to help. Sometimes, all that is needed is an opportunity to put those skills to meaningful use. Padmaja's gentle gesture reminds us that every skill has the potential to become an act of care, and every act of care can help someone live with greater comfort, dignity and ease.

VOLUNTEER DIARIES

സന്നദ്ധപ്രവർത്തകരുടെ കുറിപ്പുകൾ

Nafeesath · first visit with our team

This was my first experience in palliative care, and it really touched me. I realised that even in a small area there are many people who need care, support, and simply someone to be there for them. It made me understand that palliative care is something that can touch everyone's life at some point and is something we need to develop further across Kerala. This experience has inspired me to learn more and contribute wherever I can. I wish Arike's initiatives all the best and hope they continue to reach and support many more people.

What we did this month

പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾ



7 August · 7th anniversary



Seven years beside our neighbours

Members, volunteers, supporters and well-wishers came together to mark seven years of commitment to community-based palliative care and compassionate support, and to reflect on our continued efforts to support individuals and families living with serious illnesses.

Vaduthala

EDAPPALLY ZONE

9 August

Edappally zone meeting

Team members and volunteers met at Vaduthala to review ongoing activities, discuss local initiatives and strengthen coordination for palliative care in the zone.



19 August

Onam kit campaign at the IMA

Arike raised funds for the Onam kit initiative during the IMA general body meeting, supporting families and individuals in need during the Onam season with food kits.



21 August

An Onam spent together

IMA and Arike organised a celebration with a traditional pookalam, an onasadya and games, bringing volunteers, supporters and contributors together to celebrate the spirit of Onam.

21

ONAM KITS DELIVERED

23 August

Food kits for families

Dr. Geetha, Arun, Donal and volunteers delivered 21 Onam food kits to families in need, extending support during the Onam season.



30 August

Sensitisation at Vyttila

Mr. Suhail and Mr. Donal introduced community-based palliative care at the Dr. Palppu Kudumba Unit of the SNDP Shakha, encouraging greater community involvement in supporting people living with serious illnesses.

03 · CARE INFO · FOR FAMILIES AT HOME

Helping the patient stay hydrated

പരിചരണ കുറിപ്പ്

Adequate fluids help prevent dehydration and improve the patient's comfort and well-being. Offer small amounts of water or other preferred fluids often, rather than a large quantity at once.

- 01 Encourage the patient to drink whenever they are comfortable and able to.
- 02 Keep a cup or bottle of water within easy reach.
- 03 Offer fluids the patient enjoys, following their preference and the care team's advice.
- 04 Watch for signs of dehydration: a dry mouth, reduced urine, dark urine, or unusual weakness.
- 05 If the patient has difficulty swallowing, do not force fluids. Tell the care team instead.
- 06 Keep the lips and mouth moist for comfort, especially when they are drinking less.

Call the care team if the patient cannot drink at all, keeps vomiting, has difficulty swallowing, or shows signs of significant dehydration. Never force fluids.

Free care at home, paid for together

ഞങ്ങളെ പിന്തുണയ്ക്കുക

With your support, Arike provides free home-based palliative care to patients within the Kochi Corporation limits. On average our team cares for 40 patients every day, ensuring compassionate support in the comfort of their homes. Nearly ₹10 lakh is required every month to sustain these services, and even this is not enough to meet the growing needs of patients and extend our services to more families.

Palliative care is not limited to managing physical symptoms alone. We also support patients and families through medicines, nutritional support, and assistance for the educational needs of children. We invite you to become a monthly supporter with a minimum contribution of **₹500 per month**.

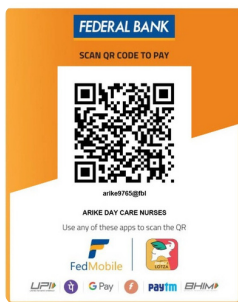
Give online

arkecare.org/donate



SCAN TO GIVE

SCAN TO GIVE · UPI



OR BANK TRANSFER

A/C name **Arike Day Care Nurses**
A/C no. **13800100459765**
IFSC **FDRL0001380**
Branch **Palarivattom, Federal Bank**
UPI **arike9765@fb1**



MOBILITY WITHOUT BARRIERS

Help us drive independence

Wheelchair users deserve barrier-free travel at zero cost. A vehicle with wheelchair access is available for travel at no cost to the family. Support our operational expenses and make every journey possible. Contribute now and empower a ride. For info, call **+91 7034 336999**.



A heartfelt thank you

നന്ദി

At Arike, every act of kindness becomes a source of strength for the patients and families we serve. We extend our deepest gratitude to all our supporters whose generosity, trust and encouragement continue to uplift our mission. Your contributions, big and small, help us deliver dignified, compassionate care to those facing serious health-related suffering.

Arike Care · 43/707, P. K. Nair Road, Palarivattom, Ernakulam 682025

info@arikecare.org · arikecare.org

Call us 24/7 - 365 days a year. [+91 7034 336999](tel:+917034336999)